Ajith Venugopal

Site Reliability / Infrastructure Engineer | CKA, CKS, AWS Solutions Architect

Infrastructure and site reliability engineer with **7+ years** building and operating **multi-cluster Kubernetes platforms** on AWS, Azure and bare metal. I own **SLIs, SLOs, error budgets and incident response** for hundreds of services across 20+ teams at Booking.com, and previously provisioned and operated **150+ clusters** spanning datacenter hardware and cloud for real-time video inside a **~40ms latency budget**. Deep **Terraform** and infrastructure-as-code practice, observability built rather than just consumed (**Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, New Relic**), GitOps delivery through **ArgoCD**, and automation in **Go, Python, TypeScript and Bash**. Currently moving toward **AI and GPU infrastructure**, where the same fleet, scheduling and performance problems apply with far more at stake per node.

Experience

DevOps Infrastructure Engineer II — Booking.com, Amsterdam

July 2022 — Present

Reliability and platform engineering for Booking.com hotels and flights.

- **Own SLIs, SLOs, error budgets and alert design** for hundreds of high-throughput services across 20+ engineering teams, with operational readiness reviews before anything reaches production
- **Operate production Kubernetes (EKS)** — autoscaling, multi-AZ resilience, topology-aware scheduling, RBAC and network isolation, zero-downtime deployments
- **Lead incident response and root-cause analysis** on an on-call rotation; chair the corrective-action (RFO) review board on a two-week cadence
- **Author Terraform modules and AWS CDK stacks** (Python, TypeScript) across multiple production environments for reproducible, self-service provisioning
- **Build observability as a capability** — metrics, tracing, logging and alerting codified across Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog and New Relic, with dashboards-as-code
- **Reduced deployment time 30%** by reworking CI/CD into concurrent and downstream stages; GitOps via ArgoCD with vulnerability and IaC scanning
- **Built AI-generated, code-change-driven service documentation**, saving ~10 engineering hours per team
- Platform security and governance — least-privilege IAM, network isolation, secrets handling; lead monthly reliability and security mob sessions and mentor engineers on SRE practice

DevOps Platform Engineer — aNewSpring, Rotterdam

August 2021 — July 2022

Sole platform engineer; led the migration off datacenter VMs to cloud-native across AWS and Azure.

- **Migrated the entire company stack** from datacenter hardware onto containerised Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), databases included, improving availability and scalability
- **Authored AWS CDK stacks** (Python) and **Terraform modules**, establishing the IaC and automation standards the organisation then worked to
- **Built CI/CD pipelines** deploying via ArgoCD into dev, staging and production with integrated test execution and IaC scanning
- Trained and mentored developers on containers, Kubernetes fundamentals and Helm

DevOps Engineer — BlueJeans by Verizon, Bengaluru

April 2019 — August 2021

Multi-cloud, hybrid infrastructure for a real-time, latency-sensitive video platform at global scale.

- **Provisioned and operated 150+ Kubernetes clusters** spanning on-premise bare-metal datacenter hardware and cloud (EKS, AKS) — fleet provisioning, lifecycle automation and node-level health management
- **Held a ~40ms latency budget** for real-time, high-throughput video under heavy user-facing traffic, with continuous capacity tuning and performance debugging across node, network and application layers
- **Managed the entire cloud, network, security and compute estate as Terraform code** and authored the reusable module library used across the organisation
- **Built monitoring, logging and alerting stacks** (Datadog, New Relic, CloudWatch, ELK, Sumologic) with dashboards-as-code and custom node and agent health checks feeding remediation
- Delivered an AWS **cost-optimisation** programme and a Python tool surfacing per-project EC2 inventory by tag; implemented Okta SSO for AWS with least-privilege IAM
- Led production database migrations (MongoDB, MySQL) from datacenter to AWS

Contact

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Skills

Kubernetes

CKA, CKS — cluster operations, autoscaling, topology-aware scheduling, networking, RBAC, Helm; bare-metal and managed control planes, 150+ cluster fleets

Cloud

AWS (Solutions Architect certified) — EKS, EC2, IAM, VPC, S3, ECS, Lambda; Microsoft Azure (AKS); bare-metal datacenter

Infrastructure as Code

Terraform, Terragrunt, AWS CDK (Python, TypeScript), CloudFormation, Ansible

Reliability & Operations

SLIs, SLOs, error budgets, alert design, capacity planning, operational readiness reviews, incident response, on-call, root-cause analysis and postmortems, toil reduction, cost optimisation

Observability

Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, New Relic, CloudWatch, ELK, Sumologic — metrics, tracing, logging, alerting, dashboards-as-code

CI/CD & Delivery

ArgoCD, Flux, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins; GitOps, progressive delivery, IaC and vulnerability scanning

Languages

Go, Python, Bash, TypeScript

Systems & Networking

Linux internals, distributed systems, performance debugging from node to application, multi-region and multi-tenant fault tolerance, low-latency high-throughput systems, disaster recovery

Security

Kubernetes security (CKS), secrets management, least-privilege IAM, network policy, governance

Certifications

— Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)
— Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
— AWS Certified Solutions Architect
— Microsoft Certified: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert

Education

M.Tech, Engineering
Vellore Institute of Technology